

Complementary and Alternative Medicine (CAM)

- Orthodox/conventional vs. unorthodox/unconventional medicine...in practice as well as curriculum
- In 2013, The National Center for Complementary and Alternative Medicine categorizes CAM into:
 - Natural products
 - Mind body practices
- In addition to these there are others like folk healing, homeopathy, and naturopathy

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- A decorative vertical bar on the left side of the slide, featuring a repeating pattern of medical icons: a red cross on a white background, a blue bandage, a blue magnifying glass, and a red cross on a white background. The icons are arranged in a grid-like fashion, with some overlapping.
- According to Goldstein (1999) there are five core elements of CAM:
 - Holism (holistic treatment)
 - The interpenetration of mind, body, and spirit
 - The possibility of high-level wellness (not just the absence of disease)
 - Vitalism (energy flow)
 - The healing process (involves both healer and patient)

Orthodox Medicine's View of Alternative Healers

- ▣ **First**, many medical doctors have considered any form of “nonscientific” healing to be quackery—a medically worthless practice—or a danger to public health
- ▣ **Second**, physicians have expressed concern that some people are fooled into believing the claims of alternative healers (legitimate and illegitimate medicine)

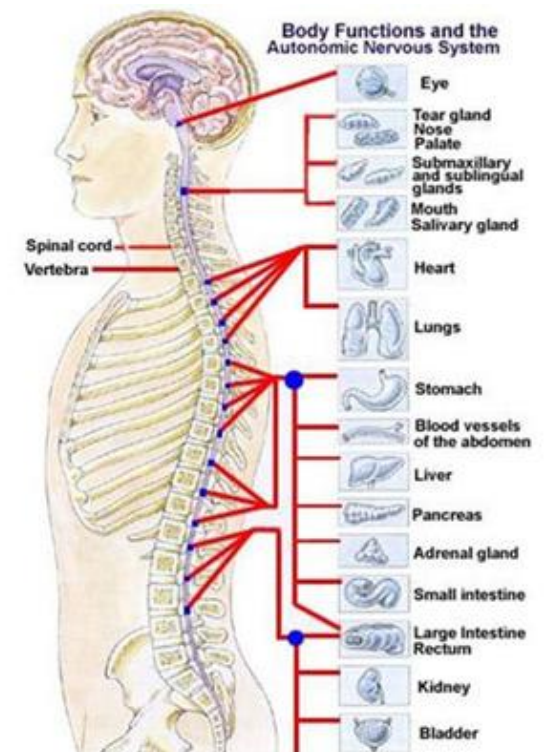
The efficacy of the CAM healers

- ▣ Most patients most of the time will recover regardless of the form of treatment received or even not received
- ▣ When patients believe strongly in the medical care they receive, it has great psychotherapeutic value
- ▣ Practitioner–patient relationship (talking, rapport, touching and giving more time)

a close and harmonious relationship in which the people or groups concerned understand each other's feelings or ideas and communicate well

Chiropractic

- The field of chiropractic was founded by Canadian-born Daniel David Palmer (1845–1913) two instances/cases
- Three basic tenets of chiropractic:
 - The body has a powerful self-healing ability (homeostasis)
 - The body's structure (primarily that of the spine) and its function are closely related
 - Therapy aims to normalize this relationship between structure and function and assists the body as it heals



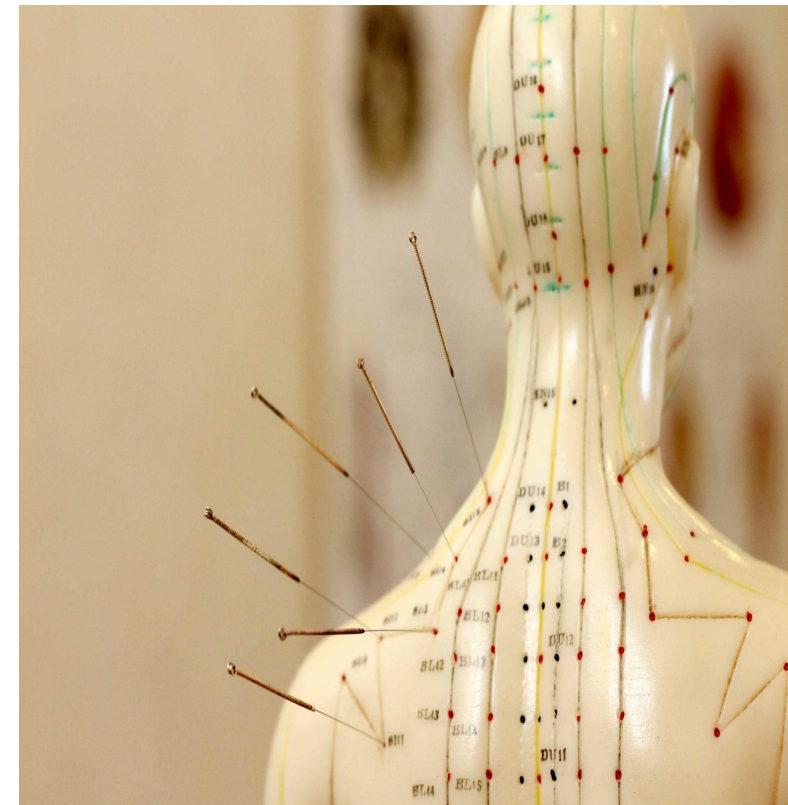
Acupuncture

- Chinese understanding of health and illness...relationship between the human body and nature
- Each object in nature is both a unified whole and a whole composed of two parts with opposing qualities: **yin** (cold, slow, and passive principle) and **yang** (hot, excited, and active principle)
- Disease occurs when the yin and yang forces become imbalanced...leads to a blockage that disrupts the flow of **chi** (vital energy providing nourishment and bodily protection) within the body
- Chi flows through the body through **channels**... represent to be connected to each vital organ
- The harmony may be disrupted either by endogenous or exogenous factors

- There are several other Chinese treatment techniques like acupressure, herbology, breathing exercise and cupping etc.

Basic Principles

- Acupuncture is the insertion of fine needles into one or more acupuncture “points” charted on the body
- Includes four aspects
 - The needles used
 - Depth to which needles are inserted
 - Duration of insertion
 - Needle rotation



Spiritual Healing

- A belief in “**psychic healing**” has been present in early and modern times and in Western and non-Western cultures
- The mechanisms may include focused wishes, meditation, prayers, ritual practices
- Psychic healers use one of four approaches:
 - **Activating** innate recuperative forces within the patient
 - **Transferring** her or his own healing energy to the patient
 - **Serving as a conduit** through which universally available **cosmic energy** is transferred to the patient
 - **Serving as a conduit** through which the healing powers of **spirits or God** are transferred to the patient
- Examples are many in India